

VIETNAM FAMILY GROUP TOUR

Hanoi & Ninh Binh — 4 Nights / 5 Days

Prepared for 12 Adults + 1 Child (age 7) | Travel dates: 15–19 October

Trip at a Glance

Time	Activity	Details
Day 1	Arrive Hanoi	15 October — airport pickup, check-in, welcome dinner
Day 2	Hanoi	16 October — full day city touring
Day 3	Hanoi → Ninh Binh	17 October — transfer with stop at Hoa Lu, boat ride on arrival
Day 4	Ninh Binh	18 October — full day countryside and caves
Day 5	Ninh Binh → Hanoi → Departure	19 October — transfer to airport for onward flight

Second location: Ninh Binh — a 2.5 to 3 hour private drive from Hanoi. It gives a completely different landscape (limestone karsts, rice paddies, private boat rides) from the city days in Hanoi, and is by far the easier logistics for a group of 13 with a 7 year old compared to an overnight Ha Long Bay cruise.

Budget Snapshot (Luxury Tier)

Time	Activity	Details
Stay — Hanoi	Sofitel Legend Metropole (per room/night)	Approx. USD 300–450 (₹25,000–37,500) for Premium/Grand Rooms; suites higher. 5–6 rooms needed for the group.
Stay — Ninh Binh	Emeralda Resort Ninh Binh (per room/night)	Approx. USD 120–180 (₹10,000–15,000) for garden/pool villa rooms; extra bed approx. USD 12/night for the child.
Airport transfer	Noi Bai ↔ Hanoi hotel (private van, one-way)	Approx. USD 35–55 (₹2,900–4,600) per vehicle, 2 vehicles needed (16-seater + car for luggage).
Hanoi ↔ Ninh Binh	Private transfer, one-way	Approx. USD 100–180 (₹8,300–15,000) per 16-seater vehicle, 2–2.5 hrs; 2 vehicles for the group.
Private guide	English-speaking, per day	Approx. USD 60–90 (₹5,000–7,500) per day for a group this size.
Trang An boat	Private boat, per boat of 4	Approx. USD 40 (₹3,300) per boat; roughly 4 boats needed for 13 people.
Water Puppet Show	Per seat	Approx. USD 6–10 (₹500–830) standard seats; VIP front-row seats slightly more. Request a reserved block of 13.
Group dinner	Private room, per person	Approx. USD 35–70 depending on venue, excludes beverages.

Day 1 — Arrival in Hanoi

Day 1 • Wednesday, 15 October • Hanoi

Time	Activity	Details
On arrival	Airport welcome	Private meet & greet at Noi Bai International Airport. Fast-track immigration assistance arranged for the group. Placards with family name for easy identification.
+45 min	Transfer to hotel	Private vehicles (recommend one 16-seater coach plus one car for luggage/overflow) to Hanoi Old Quarter / French Quarter, approx. 45 minutes depending on traffic.
On arrival	Check-in	Recommended: Sofitel Legend Metropole Hanoi (Hoan Kiem, walking distance to Old Quarter), Grand/Premium Rooms, approx. USD 300–450/night. Alternative: Capella Hanoi for a more contemporary, design-led stay at a similar rate. 5–6 rooms pre-blocked and pre-registered so the group isn't standing at the desk together. Welcome refreshments in the lobby or a private lounge.
Evening	Rest / leisure	Free time to settle in, unpack, and recover from the flight.
20:00	Welcome dinner	Private room at Ngon Villa (garden-set Vietnamese, approx. USD 25–35 pp) or Sofitel's own Le Club/rooftop for skyline views (approx. USD 45–60 pp). Kids' menu and a high chair requested in advance.

Day 2 — Hanoi, Full Day

Day 2 • Thursday, 16 October • Hanoi

Time	Activity	Details
07:30	Breakfast	At the hotel.
09:00	Old Quarter walking tour	Private English-speaking guide, approx. USD 60–90 for the day (covers the full day's touring, not just this slot). Easy pace, plenty of shade breaks — comfortable for the child and any older members of the group.
10:30	Hoan Kiem Lake & Ngoc Son Temple	Short walk from the Old Quarter. A calm, scenic stop with good photo opportunities.
11:30	Train Street	Timed to coincide with a train passing through — we'll confirm the exact daily schedule closer to the date, as it shifts seasonally.
13:00	Lunch	Private room, group-style Vietnamese spread (pho, bun cha, spring rolls) — approx. USD 20–30 pp at a mid-luxury Old Quarter restaurant. Vegetarian and any dietary requirements flagged in advance.
15:00	Temple of Literature	Vietnam's first university, quieter in the afternoon. About 30–40 minutes.
16:30	Free time	Café hopping and shopping in the Old Quarter — egg coffee is a local specialty worth trying.

Time	Activity	Details
18:00	Water Puppet Show	Thang Long Water Puppet Theatre. Approx. USD 6–10 per standard seat, slightly more for VIP front rows. Recommend booking a reserved block of 13 seats together in advance — this sells out, especially in peak season.
20:00	Dinner	Group dinner (approx. USD 30–45 pp), or a hands-on cooking class / demonstration dinner (approx. USD 45–65 pp) if the family would enjoy something more interactive on this evening.

Day 3 — Hanoi to Ninh Binh

Day 3 • Friday, 17 October • Hanoi → Ninh Binh

Time	Activity	Details
08:00	Breakfast & check-out	At the hotel.
09:00	Depart for Ninh Binh	Private vehicles (2 x 16-seater or similar), approx. USD 100–180 per vehicle one-way, approximately 2.5–3 hours depending on traffic out of Hanoi.
En route	Hoa Lu Ancient Capital	Roughly 45-minute stop at the temples of the Dinh and Le dynasties, Vietnam's first capital. Entrance approx. USD 1.50 pp. Breaks up the drive well.
12:30	Arrival & check-in	Emeralda Resort Ninh Binh (Van Long Nature Reserve, approx. 90 min from Hanoi) — spacious villa-style rooms, approx. USD 120–180/night, gardens, 3 pools. Ideally one property that can hold the whole group together rather than splitting across hotels.
13:30	Lunch	Riverside restaurant, local specialties (goat meat, rice wine, mountain greens) — approx. USD 15–25 pp.
15:00	Trang An boat tour	2.5–3 hours through the limestone caves and grottoes by rowboat. Approx. USD 10 pp standard, or approx. USD 40 per private boat (4 seats) if we book out full boats for the group — roughly 4 boats needed. Life jackets sized for the child confirmed in advance.
18:30	Return to resort	Rest and freshen up.
20:00	Dinner	At the resort (approx. USD 25–35 pp), or a countryside restaurant with a bonfire / local folk music set-up (approx. USD 30–45 pp) if the family wants something a bit more atmospheric.

Day 4 — Ninh Binh, Full Day

Day 4 · Saturday, 18 October · Ninh Binh

Time	Activity	Details
07:30	Breakfast	At the resort.
09:00	Cycling through rice paddies	Easy countryside cycling route, approx. USD 12–18 pp including bike rental. E-bikes available for anyone who'd prefer not to pedal (approx. USD 20–25 pp); the child can ride tandem or in a cart with a parent.
11:00	Mua Cave viewpoint (optional)	Entrance approx. USD 2.50 pp. About 500 steps to the top for panoramic views. Best treated as optional — we'd suggest splitting the group so those keen to climb can go, while others enjoy resort/pool time instead.
13:00	Lunch	Local restaurant near Tam Coc, approx. USD 15–20 pp.
15:00	Tam Coc boat ride	Approx. USD 10 pp standard / approx. USD 40 per private boat of 4 — a gentler, more scenic alternative to Trang An. Good option for a second boat experience without repeating the same route, or can be swapped for resort/spa free time.
18:00	Return to resort	Rest before the evening.
19:30	Farewell dinner	Private set-up — candlelit riverside dinner or a table with a local folk music performance, approx. USD 35–50 pp, as a closing evening for the trip.

Day 5 — Departure

Day 5 · Sunday, 19 October · Ninh Binh → Hanoi → Departure

Time	Activity	Details
07:00	Breakfast & check-out	At the resort.
08:00	Depart for Hanoi airport	Private vehicles, approx. USD 100–180 per vehicle. Approximately 2.5–3 hours, with a buffer built in for traffic. We'll confirm exact departure time once outbound flight details are shared, aiming to arrive at the airport 3 hours ahead of an international flight.
On arrival	Airport drop-off	Assistance with check-in for the group where possible.

Stays Shortlist

Hanoi

- Sofitel Legend Metropole Hanoi — Old Quarter edge, colonial-era icon, approx. USD 300–450/night for Grand/Premium Rooms. Best all-round fit for a large family group needing central location and full service. Note: Opera Wing is under phased refurbishment through late September 2026, unaffected by our travel dates.
- Capella Hanoi — French Quarter, design-led and more contemporary, similar rate band. Good alternative if the family wants something less traditional.

- Lotte Hotel Hanoi — West Lake area, larger rooms, good for families wanting more space and a quieter base, approx. USD 200–320/night.

Ninh Binh

- Emeralda Resort Ninh Binh (Van Long Nature Reserve) — villa-style rooms, 3 pools, approx. USD 120–180/night, about 90 minutes from Hanoi. Recommended as the whole-group property.
- Emeralda Resort Tam Coc — sister property closer to the Tam Coc boat launch, approx. USD 135+/night, useful if the family prioritises walking to the boats over the Van Long setting.

Dining Reservations to Lock In

- Welcome dinner, Hanoi — Day 1 evening (private room, kids' menu)
- Group lunch, Old Quarter — Day 2 (dietary requirements confirmed in advance)
- Optional cooking class dinner, Hanoi — Day 2 evening
- Riverside lunch, Ninh Binh — Day 3, on arrival
- Farewell dinner, Ninh Binh — Day 4 evening (private set-up)

All restaurants to be pre-briefed on group size (13 pax, including one child) so tables and timing are held rather than confirmed on the day.

Special Requests & Private Access

- Private, English-speaking guide (or Hindi-speaking, if that's a preference for the family) for the full 5 days
- Reserved block of seats for the Water Puppet Show — this venue sells out and doesn't hold group blocks casually
- Private boats for both Trang An and Tam Coc, rather than shared boats with other tourists
- Fast-track / meet & greet on arrival and departure at Noi Bai Airport
- Villa or connected room block rather than scattered standard rooms, in both Hanoi and Ninh Binh
- Life jacket and seating arrangements confirmed in advance for the child on all boat rides
- Kids' menu, high chair, and early meal timing flagged with every restaurant

What We Still Need From the Family

- Exact arrival and departure flight numbers and timings, to finalise airport transfer windows
- Any dietary restrictions across the group (vegetarian, Jain, allergies, etc.)
- Passport copies for visa processing — Vietnam e-visa is straightforward but needs lead time
- Preference on Ninh Binh vs. Ha Long Bay for the second location, if a cruise experience is something they'd specifically like instead
- Any mobility considerations in the group — this affects whether we build in Mua Cave, how much walking we plan into the Old Quarter tour, etc.
- Preferred room configuration — how the 12 adults are arranged as couples/families for room-blocking

A Few Things Worth Flagging

- Mid-October sits at the tail end of Northern Vietnam's rainy season, and this is also typhoon season for the coast, so a day or two of rain is possible. Nothing in this plan depends on clear skies, but we'd suggest travel insurance and keeping the Mua Cave climb and boat rides flexible on timing.
- 13 people is a comfortable size for one 16-seater vehicle, but we'd still recommend a second car for luggage and overflow, especially for the Hanoi–Ninh Binh transfers.
- Vietnam is largely cash-friendly outside major hotels; a currency exchange or local SIM/eSIM briefing on arrival is a small but useful touch for a first-time group.

Visual Reference Guide

Photo placeholders below, organised by category and matched to the itinerary. Drop in the visuals your team already has (Chetto, Instagram inspo, Google) or the ones sourced in chat — each box is sized for a 1200 × 800px landscape image.

Hanoi — Stays



Sofitel Legend Metropole Hanoi

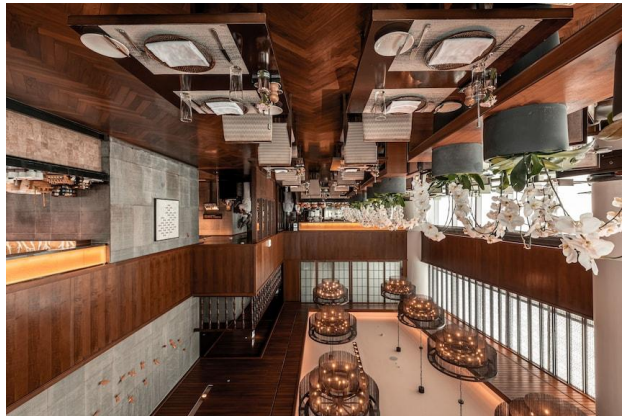


Capella Hanoi





Lotte Hotel Hanoi ·



Ninh Binh — Stays



Emeralda Resort Ninh Binh ·



Hanoi — Places & Activities (Day 1–2)



Hanoi Old Quarter

Hoan Kiem Lake & Ngoc Son Temple



Train Street



Temple of Literature



Thang Long Water Puppet Theatre



Ninh Binh – Places & Activities (Day 3–4)

Hoa Lu Ancient Capital



Trang An Boat Tour

Tam Coc Boat Ride

